

## Introduction to phishing

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**SIEM TOOL:** Splunk

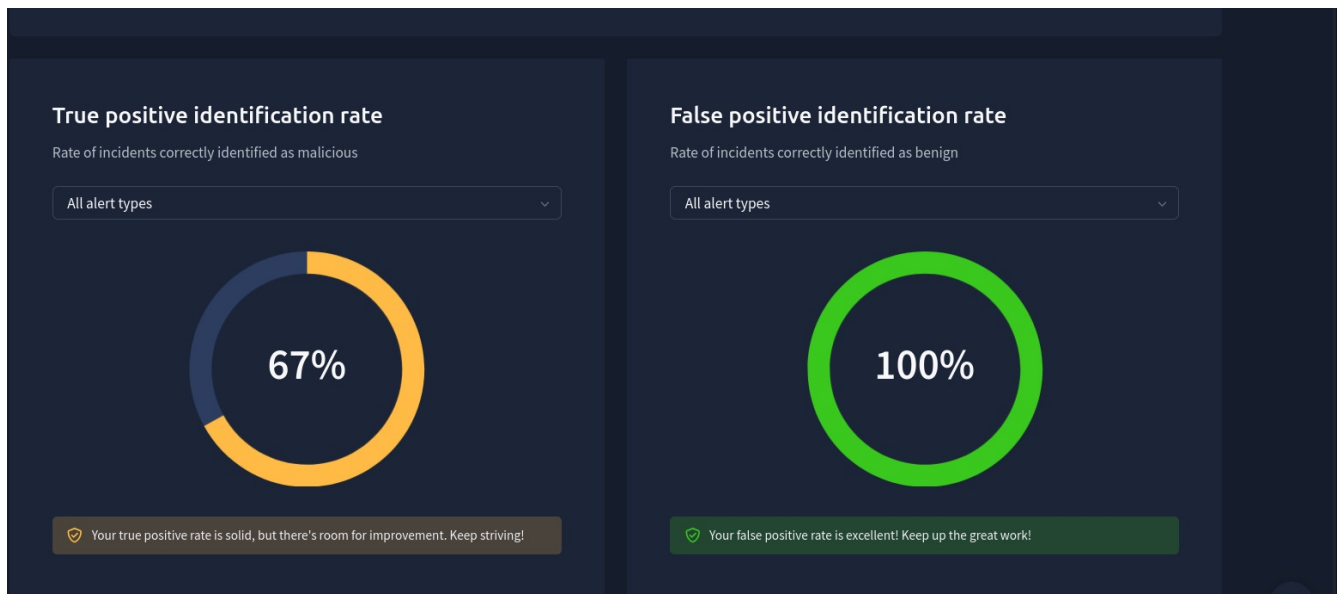
### Scenario objectives

- Monitor and analyze real-time alerts.
- Identify and document critical events such as suspicious emails and attachments.
- Create detailed case reports based on your observations to help your team understand the full scope of alerts and malicious activity.

### Steps:

For each alerts, I investigated them as needed, and take appropriate actions to resolve or close them.

- Take ownership of an alert
- Investigate with Splunk
- Write findings as report



## ALERT 1

### Description:

This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.

**Subject:** Action Required: Finalize Your Onboarding Profile

**sender:** [onboarding@hrconnex.thm](mailto:onboarding@hrconnex.thm)

The external links and email are from a third party partner [hrconnex.thm](https://hrconnex.thm)

```
> 5/28/26 { [-]
9:41:08.560 AM attachment: None
content: Hi IT Team,\n\nHope you're doing well! I'm reaching out because one of our new hires, J. Garcia, hasn't received her onboarding email from hrconnex.thm, which
is our new third-party HR partner for handling account setup and paperwork.\n\nHe was supposed to receive a link to complete her profile and sign some documents, but it
hasn't come through - not in her inbox or spam. We've double-checked the email address on our end, and it's correct.\n\nLet me know if you need any more info from my side.
\n\n
datasource: email
direction: internal
recipient: j.carter@thetrydaily.thm
sender: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm
subject: Unable to Receive Onboarding Email from hrconnex.thm
timestamp: 05/28/2026 10:41:08.560
}
Show as raw text
host = 10.10.136.251:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json
```

### Incident report

Incident classification

☐ True positive

☒ False positive

Closure rationale

Explain why you have identified this incident as a false positive.

B I U A ▼ ≡ ≡ ≡ ▼

This email is from the third party Hr company . the email was sent on 05/28/2026 at 10:45:34.560 and the recipient was j.garcia@thetrydaily.thm a junior employee. the reason it was flagged is because it came from a third party company onboarding@hrconnex.thm

Submit and close alert

## ALERT 2

### Description:

This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.

**Subject:** Unusual Sign-In Activity on Your Microsoft Account

**sender:** no-reply@microsoftsupport.co

### Incident report

Incident classification

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

☒ True positive ☐ False positive

B I U A ▾ ≡ ≡ ≡ ▾

This alert happened on 05/28/2026 at 10:45:06.560 for a brand impersonation phishing attack targeting c.allen@thetrydaily.thm. The threat actor is using a false domain (microsoftsupport.co) and a fake security warning to induce panic and harvest corporate Microsoft credentials via a malicious login link. If a user clicks the link the attacker will obtain the credentials. sender: no-reply@microsoftsupport.co, id recommend blocking the domain microsoftsupport.co from the users inbox and then adding it ti the firewalls block list. if the user clicked it then recommend a password reset and revoke all the oath tokens/sessions.

☐ Yes ☐ No

## ALERT 3

### Description:

This alert was triggered when a user attempted to access an external URL that is listed in the organization's blacklist or threat intelligence feeds. The firewall or proxy successfully blocked the outbound request, preventing the connection. Note: The blacklist only covers known threats. It does not guarantee protection against new or unknown malicious domains.

### Incident report

Incident classification

☐ True positive ☒ False positive

Closure rationale

Explain why you have identified this incident as a false positive.

B I U A ▾ ≡ ≡ ≡ ▾

This event occurred on 05/28/2026 at 10:44:02.560 the SourceIP: 10.20.2.17, DestinationIP: 67.199.248.11, DestinationPort: 80, URL: http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340 Application: web-browsing, Protocol: TCP. The reason i identified the incident as a false flag is because it came from an employee and not an external actor , since the firewall already blocked it it doesn't have any malicious impact

Submit and close alert

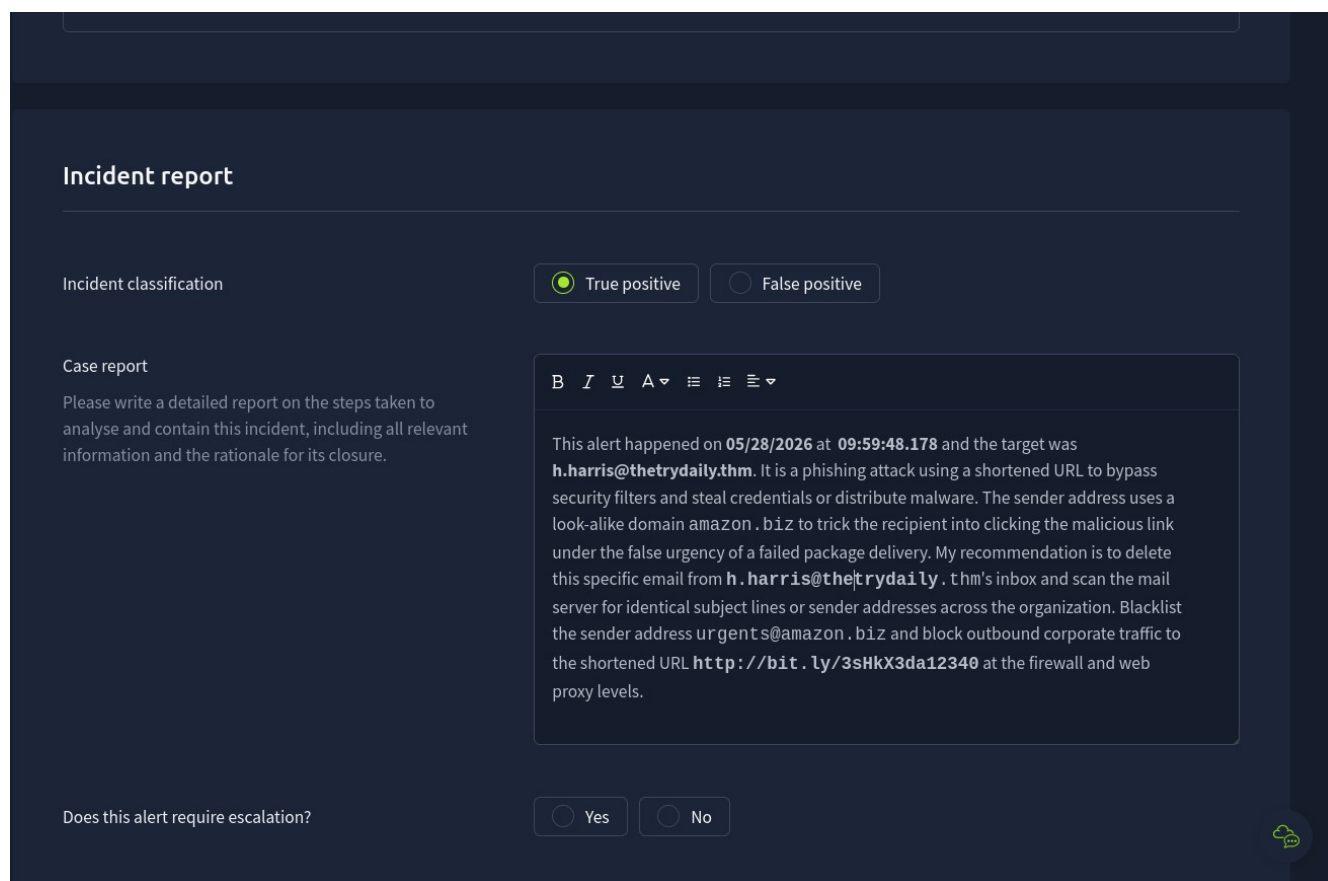
## ALERT 4

### Description:

This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.

**Subject:** Your Amazon Package Couldn't Be Delivered – Action Required

**sender:** [urgents@amazon.biz](mailto:urgents@amazon.biz)



The screenshot shows a dark-themed incident report form. At the top, it says "Incident report". Below this, there are two sections: "Incident classification" and "Case report".

**Incident classification:** This section has two radio buttons. The first is labeled "True positive" and is selected (indicated by a green dot). The second is labeled "False positive" and is not selected.

**Case report:** This section has a text area for writing a detailed report. The text area contains the following text: "This alert happened on 05/28/2026 at 09:59:48.178 and the target was h.harris@thetrydaily.thm. It is a phishing attack using a shortened URL to bypass security filters and steal credentials or distribute malware. The sender address uses a look-alike domain amazon . biz to trick the recipient into clicking the malicious link under the false urgency of a failed package delivery. My recommendation is to delete this specific email from h . harris@thetrydaily . thm's inbox and scan the mail server for identical subject lines or sender addresses across the organization. Blacklist the sender address urgents@amazon . biz and block outbound corporate traffic to the shortened URL http://bit . ly/3sHkX3da12340 at the firewall and web proxy levels." The text area has a rich text editor toolbar at the top with icons for bold, italic, underline, text color, background color, bulleted list, numbered list, and link.

**Does this alert require escalation?** This section has two radio buttons. The first is labeled "Yes" and is not selected. The second is labeled "No" and is not selected.

## Alert 5

### Description:

This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.

**Subject:** Action Required: Finalize Your Onboarding Profile.

In this scenario I discovered that the company has a third party hr partner so the incident posses no threat to the company.

Stats

